

Round 3 — “The Investigation”

11:00 PM – Midnight

Scene: Hard evidence. Investigation by conversation. Press the alibis. Look at the body. Open bags. Two visual climaxes anchor the round (the five browns, then Val cleared / Marco’s eyewitness moment) — these are run by characters in the room, not by the host.

- **Share in conversation:**
 - When Irina pulls out the burnt note and names Gloria, **stunned silence**. Don’t interrupt her.
 - If Zoya brings up your past: “I was someone else before this. That person is gone. I tend bar now.”
- **Seek out:** Irina (when she’s ready to break, be near her), Jimmy (you owe him a thank-you).

Your moment to drive — the thermos contrast (Five Browns climax)

This is the visual climax of the night. After Sunny crosses to Gloria, demands her bag, peels back the masking tape on the Sharpie (“you are not diabetic. And this is a Sharpie.”), and lines up the Sharpie + collar + handkerchief + Gloria’s stained cuff + the powder from Irina’s coffee tin — five matching browns on the table — Sunny will turn to the bar.

- **Sunny calls: “Mr. Calloway. The thermos.”**
- Pull the thermos out from under the bar. Unscrew the lid. **Steam rises.** Pour a cup on the bartop — real coffee, different shade.
- Deliver: *“It’s coffee. Smell it. It’s been coffee for six months.”*
- Sunny finishes the contrast: *“That is coffee. This is the same brown as the stain on Ms. Rathbone’s collar.”* Let him close it. Step back behind the bar.